Husky Helper

The UW Guide That Actually Knows You

AI-Powered Personalized Onboarding for UW International Students

MSIS 522 | University of Washington

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THE PROBLEM

~63,000

students in UW

With

8470

international students

facing the same overwhelming challenge

Within their first weeks, students must navigate:

- Housing scams & bad lease agreements
- No US bank account, no SSN, no credit history
- F-1 visa compliance & SEVIS requirements
- Unknown US academic culture norms
- OPT/CPT timelines & career integration

Current resources — orientation packets, Reddit, Facebook groups — are static, overwhelming, and NOT personalized.

OUR SOLUTION

"The Husky Helper That Actually Knows You"

Built on Husky Helper (MSIS 549) — upgraded with AI, personalization & multilingual support

RAG Chatbot

Claude API + Supabase KB

- 688 entries × 10 languages
- UW-specific knowledge base
- Source-cited answers

Personalized Onboarding

Profile-aware planning

- Country + Program + Budget
- Enrollment quarter aware
- Tailored action checklist

10 Languages

True multilingual support

- Chinese, Korean, Japanese
- Hindi, Vietnamese, Arabic
- Spanish, French, Russian

Unlike ChatGPT or Gemini — Husky Helper knows your country, budget, program, and arrival quarter

LIVE DEMO

husky-helper.lovable.app

Demo Persona: Student from China | MSIS Graduate | Budget $1,100/month | Autumn 2026

01 Personalized Onboarding Plan

Fill intake form (country, program, budget, quarter) → tailored checklist: SEVIS check-in, East West Bank, CSSA contacts — specific to Chinese MSIS student arriving Autumn 2026

02 Housing: "Where should I live near UW?"

Budget-aware neighborhood comparison (Roosevelt ~$1,300 vs U-District ~$1,600), rental scam red flags, lease agreement checklist with Washington State tenant rights

03 Banking: "Which bank if I have no SSN?"

East West Bank (Chinese-speaking staff) + Chase recommendation with F-1 step-by-step guide. Source cited → iss.washington.edu official page

04 Academic Culture: "How do I email a professor?"

Culturally appropriate template with UW norms explained. Contrast vs generic ChatGPT answer — shows personalization advantage clearly to judges

TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

USER QUERY

Natural language
10 languages
supported

RAG RETRIEVAL

688 KB entries
Supabase query
Keyword match

CLAUDE API

Personalized
system prompt
claude-sonnet

RESPONSE

Source-cited
Profile-aware
Multilingual

Official Data Sources

UW ISS

iss.washington.edu

UW Housing

housing.uw.edu

UW SFS

finance.uw.edu/sfs

UW Careers

careers.uw.edu

KNOWLEDGE BASE COVERAGE

688
KB Entries

10
Languages

11
Categories

9
Data Sources

Pre-Arrival & Onboarding

- ISSS check-in & SEVIS
- Husky Card & MyUW setup
- Neighborhood comparisons
- Housing search strategies

Financial Setup

- Bank account without SSN
- Building US credit from zero
- F-1 tax obligations (8843)
- Sending money home

Academic Culture

- Email etiquette w/ professors
- Office hours norms
- Group project dynamics
- GPA & grading culture

Career Integration

- OPT/CPT timelines
- H-1B lottery strategy
- LinkedIn in US tech
- Informational interviews

IMPACT & SCALABILITY

SOCIAL IMPACT

- Reduces housing scam risk for new arrivals
- Prevents F-1 visa compliance mistakes
- Bridges cultural gap in academic norms
- Available 24/7 — no office hours needed
- Works in student's native language
- Proactively surfaces the right info at the right time

SCALABILITY

UW is the pilot, not the ceiling

1.1M	intl students in the US per year
1,000+	US universities to deploy
RAG + Profile	architecture generalizes to any school

Next: pgvector semantic search | Task-oriented UX | Multi-university pilot

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Thank you!